Lab 11: Critique and Accessibility Sprint

Level: Advanced Suggested time: 75 minutes Platform: Complete the core brief in either Procreate or Sketchbook Studio; use the comparison notes to transfer the workflow. Alignment: K4 | K6 | K7 | K8 | A1 | A4 | LO3

Scenario

A boutique hotel has a beautiful handwashing poster, but guests miss key instructions and report visual overload.

Your role: Design reviewer Required deliverable: An evidence-based critique, annotated revision plan and improved draft.

Learning goal

Apply Observe-interpret-connect-propose | hierarchy | contrast | colour independence | sensory load to a real design decision and produce evidence that meets explicit acceptance criteria.

Before you begin

- Use an iPad that supports your chosen app and a compatible stylus where available.
- Save an editable, layered master before exporting a flattened image.
- Use only owned, licensed or clearly permitted reference images and record their sources.
- Create a folder named Lab-11-<YourName> for working files and evidence.

Part A - Plan and construct

1. Open the supplied or facilitator-provided luxury-hotel handwashing poster draft.
2. Restate its users, task, context, luxury association and non-negotiable instruction sequence.
3. Record at least five neutral observations before giving any judgement.
4. For each observation, interpret the user impact and connect it to function, hierarchy, emotion or human factors.
5. Prioritise the top three issues by severity and evidence, not personal taste.
6. Create an annotated revision plan and implement one hierarchy change, one accessibility change and one sensory-load change.
7. Run greyscale, thumbnail and five-second comprehension checks; export before/after evidence.

Part B - Procreate pathway

1. Import the draft or open a duplicate so the original remains unchanged.
2. Create an Annotations layer and mark focal path, contrast problems, tangencies and clutter.
3. Use Selection and Transform to test hierarchy changes before repainting.
4. Use Alpha Lock/clipping layers to test colour and contrast revisions non-destructively.
5. Use a temporary greyscale check and reduce the canvas to thumbnail size.
6. Create a Revision Notes text layer or keep notes in the lab document; do not rasterise until approved.
7. Export side-by-side before/after evidence and the revised layered file.

Part C - Sketchbook Studio pathway

1. Import the draft as a reference overlay or open a duplicate layered file.
2. Create an annotation layer and mark evidence without changing the original.
3. Use duplicate/reorder/hide controls to compare revision variants.
4. Use Mono to test colour-independent meaning; use reduced zoom for thumbnail comprehension.
5. Change hierarchy through scale, position, contrast and quiet space before adding effects.
6. Use filters only on duplicated layers and keep the evidence trail.
7. Export before, annotation and after images plus the critique record.

Evidence and acceptance checklist

[ ] At least five observations are evidence-based

[ ] Every proposed change maps to function or sensory appeal

[ ] Meaning survives greyscale and thumbnail checks

[ ] Revision keeps a credible luxury association

[ ] Layered working file is saved and opens correctly.

[ ] Final export uses a clear filename and matches the intended dimensions.

[ ] At least one in-progress screenshot shows the technique in use.

[ ] Reference sources and design decisions are recorded.

Peer review questions

1. Which attractive element harms function?
2. What evidence separates overload from preference?
3. How does the revision create a positive hotel association?

Debrief

Use the Observe → Interpret → Connect → Propose pattern:

1. Observe: State what is visible without praise or blame.
2. Interpret: Explain the likely effect on attention, meaning, emotion or use.
3. Connect: Link the effect to the brief, a design principle or the acceptance criteria.
4. Propose: Name one specific change and how you will check whether it works.

Record one decision you will keep, one change you will test, and one technique you can transfer to the other app.

Troubleshooting

- The line feels wobbly: Zoom out, slow the decision rather than the stroke, use shoulder movement, and increase stabilisation only enough to preserve intent.
- Colour leaks during fill: Close the contour, inspect gaps at 100%, or place colour on a separate layer and clean with the precise eraser.
- The file becomes hard to edit: Name or document layer roles, hide unused experiments, group related stages and duplicate before merging or filtering.
- The image looks muddy: Check value grouping, lower overlay opacity, remove competing texture and restore one clear focal contrast.

- Perspective feels wrong: Return to horizon and vanishing logic; correct the large box before windows, props or decoration.

Submission package

Submit Lab-11-<YourName>/ containing:

- layered working file (or the app's saved layered sketch);
- final PNG/JPEG/PDF as required by the brief;
- progress evidence/contact sheet;
- short design rationale answering the peer-review questions; and
- reference/provenance list.

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